

MERIDIAN & ASSOCIATES LLP

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Execution Team Bios

Extended Senior Consultant & Staff Profiles

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5. Olivia Brennan, CBAP

Senior Consultant, Business Analyst / Testing Lead

Years of Experience: 4 years

Office: Chicago, IL

Email: o.brennan@meridian-llp.com

Professional Summary

Olivia Brennan is a Senior Consultant in Meridian's Advisory Practice, serving as a Business Analyst and Testing Lead on large-scale technology implementation programs. Over her 4-year career, Olivia has contributed to 7 enterprise engagements spanning ERP implementations, post-merger integrations, and cloud migration programs. She is recognized for her meticulous requirements traceability, rigorous test strategy design, and ability to coordinate UAT efforts involving 100+ business users across multiple workstreams.

Education

- MS, Information Systems Management, Carnegie Mellon University (2022)
- BS, Industrial Engineering, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign (2020)

Certifications

- Certified Business Analysis Professional (CBAP), IIBA
- ISTQB Certified Tester - Advanced Level (Test Analyst)
- SAFe 5 Practitioner
- Jira Administration Certified

Technical Skills

- **Business Analysis:** Requirements elicitation, process modeling (BPMN), user stories, acceptance criteria, traceability matrices
- **Testing:** Test strategy design, test case development, UAT coordination, defect management, regression testing
- **Tools:** Jira, Confluence, Azure DevOps, HP ALM/Quality Center, Zephyr, Selenium (basic), Postman
- **Data Analysis:** SQL, Excel/VBA (advanced), Power BI, Python (pandas)
- **Methodologies:** Agile (Scrum, SAFe), Waterfall, Hybrid

Project Contributions

- **Fortune 200 Manufacturer - SAP S/4HANA:** Served as Testing Lead for 16-month SAP greenfield implementation. Designed test strategy covering 1,200+ test cases across MM, PP, SD, and FI modules. Coordinated 3 UAT cycles with 120 business users and achieved zero critical defects at go-live. Worked closely with David Kim's team on cutover planning.
- **12-Hospital Health System Merger:** Led business analysis for revenue cycle workstream during post-merger integration. Documented 42 AS-IS and TO-BE processes for patient access, coding, and claims management. Facilitated requirements workshops with 85

stakeholders across both legacy networks.

- **State Government Cloud Migration:** Managed application portfolio rationalization analysis for 1,800 applications. Assessed each application against 6R framework (rehost, replatform, refactor, repurchase, retain, retire) and maintained requirements traceability for 340 applications selected for migration.

Training Completed

- Meridian BA/QA Excellence Program (2023)
- SAP S/4HANA Business Process Integration - Internal Course (2024)
- Meridian Leadership Essentials Program (2025)

6. Kwame Asante, SAP S/4HANA Certified

Senior Consultant, SAP FICO Functional

Years of Experience: 5 years

Office: Chicago, IL

Email: k.asante@meridian-llp.com

Professional Summary

Kwame Asante is a Senior Consultant specializing in SAP Finance (FI) and Controlling (CO) functional configuration for S/4HANA environments. With 5 years of experience, Kwame has contributed to 6 full-lifecycle SAP implementations and 3 system conversion projects across manufacturing, energy, and retail industries. He is recognized for his expertise in the Universal Journal, New Asset Accounting, and SAP Central Finance, as well as his ability to configure complex intercompany and multi-currency scenarios.

Education

- MS, Accounting, University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign (2021)
- BBA, Finance & Information Systems, University of Ghana (2019)

Certifications

- SAP Certified Application Associate - SAP S/4HANA Finance
- SAP Certified Application Associate - SAP S/4HANA Management Accounting
- CPA Candidate (3 of 4 sections passed)
- SAFe 5 Practitioner

Technical Skills

- **SAP Modules:** FI (GL, AP, AR, AA, BL), CO (CCA, PCA, IO, PA), Treasury (TRM), Intercompany
- **S/4HANA Specific:** Universal Journal, New Asset Accounting, Central Finance, Group Reporting
- **Integration:** SAP CPI, IDocs, BAPIs, integration with Concur, Ariba, SuccessFactors
- **Reporting:** SAP Analytics Cloud, Embedded Analytics, CDS Views, Fiori apps
- **Migration:** SAP LSMW, BODS, Syniti, custom ABAP data migration programs

Project Contributions

- **Top-5 US Integrated Energy Company:** Led SAP S/4HANA Finance configuration for corporate and refinery operations covering 14 company codes, 8 currencies, and complex intercompany elimination scenarios. Configured New Asset Accounting for \$18B in fixed assets and designed integration with Azure-based ESG data platform for emissions cost allocation. (See Energy Case Study)
- **Mid-Market Specialty Retailer:** Configured SAP FI/CO for 340-store retailer during ECC-to-S/4HANA conversion. Designed profitability analysis (CO-PA) configuration enabling real-time margin reporting by store, channel, and product category. Migrated 8 years of financial history with zero reconciliation differences.

- **Aerospace Manufacturer:** Configured SAP Treasury and Cash Management for \$2.4B revenue defense contractor. Implemented automated bank statement processing, cash pooling, and multi-currency hedge accounting compliant with ASC 815 requirements.

Training Completed

- SAP S/4HANA Finance Deep Dive (SAP Official, 2024)
- Meridian SAP Academy - Advanced Track (2023)
- Meridian Consulting Excellence Program (2024)

7. Jessica Huang

Consultant, Data Engineering

Years of Experience: 3 years

Office: San Francisco, CA

Email: j.huang@meridian-llp.com

Professional Summary

Jessica Huang is a Consultant in Meridian's Data & Analytics practice, specializing in data pipeline development, cloud data platform implementation, and data quality engineering. In her 3 years at the firm, Jessica has contributed to 6 client engagements across energy, retail, and financial services sectors. She is recognized for her expertise in modern data stack technologies (dbt, Snowflake, Databricks) and her ability to build production-grade data pipelines that reliably process terabytes of data with robust testing and monitoring.

Education

- MS, Computer Science (Data Systems track), University of Wisconsin-Madison (2023)
- BS, Mathematics & Statistics, UC San Diego (2021)

Certifications

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Engineer Associate (DP-203)
- dbt Analytics Engineering Certification
- Databricks Certified Data Engineer Associate
- Snowflake SnowPro Core Certification

Technical Skills

- **Data Engineering:** dbt, Apache Spark, Apache Airflow, Dagster, Delta Lake, Apache Iceberg
- **Cloud Platforms:** Azure (Data Factory, Synapse, ADLS Gen2, Event Hubs), AWS (Glue, Redshift, S3)
- **Data Warehouses:** Snowflake, Databricks Unity Catalog, BigQuery
- **Programming:** Python, SQL, Scala, Bash
- **Data Quality:** Great Expectations, dbt tests, Monte Carlo, Soda
- **Orchestration & CI/CD:** Airflow, Dagster, GitHub Actions, Terraform

Project Contributions

- **Integrated Energy Company - ESG Platform:** Built data pipelines ingesting real-time IoT sensor data from 2,400+ emissions monitoring points across 8 refineries into Azure Event Hubs and Delta Lake. Implemented dbt transformations for SEC Climate Rule-compliant emissions calculations with full data lineage and audit trail. (See Energy Case Study)
- **National Retailer - Demand Forecasting Platform:** Developed Snowflake data pipelines processing daily POS transactions from 800+ stores (2.4M records/day). Built dbt models for demand signal aggregation supporting

ML-powered forecasting models deployed by Raj Krishnamurthy's team. (See Retail Case Study)

- **Financial Services - Regulatory Reporting:** Built automated data pipeline for CCAR stress testing on AWS, replacing 120 person-hours of manual data preparation with Airflow-orchestrated ETL processing in under 4 hours. Implemented Great Expectations data quality checks with 99.98% validation pass rate.

Training Completed

- Meridian Data Engineering Foundations Program (2023)
- Advanced dbt Patterns - Internal Course (2024)
- Meridian Professional Communications Workshop (2024)
- Databricks Certified Data Engineer Professional - In Progress

8. Derek Williams

Staff, Project Coordinator / PMO

Years of Experience: 2 years

Office: New York, NY

Email: d.williams@meridian-llp.com

Professional Summary

Derek Williams is a Staff member in Meridian's Program Management Office (PMO), providing project coordination and administrative support for large-scale advisory and technology engagements. Despite being early in his career, Derek has already contributed to 4 major programs, demonstrating exceptional organizational skills, attention to detail, and the ability to manage complex project schedules, RAID logs, and stakeholder communications across multi-workstream programs with 50-120 person teams.

Education

- BS, Business Administration (Project Management concentration), Penn State University (2024)
- Minor in Information Sciences and Technology

Certifications

- Certified Associate in Project Management (CAPM), PMI
- Smartsheet Product Certified User
- Smartsheet System Administrator Certification
- Microsoft Project Certified Associate
- SAFe 5 Practitioner - In Progress

Technical Skills

- **Project Management:** Schedule management, RAID log maintenance, resource tracking, meeting facilitation, status reporting
- **Tools:** Smartsheet, Microsoft Project, Jira, Confluence, Monday.com, SharePoint
- **Reporting:** Power BI dashboards, Excel (advanced), PowerPoint executive decks
- **Methodologies:** PMI PMBOK, Agile (Scrum), SAFe (basic), Waterfall
- **Communication:** Steering committee minutes, weekly status reports, stakeholder RACI matrices

Project Contributions

- **National Retailer - Omnichannel Transformation:** Served as PMO Coordinator for 20-month, 75-person program. Maintained integrated project schedule across 6 workstreams in Smartsheet, tracked 280+ deliverables, facilitated weekly status meetings, and produced executive steering committee decks. Program delivered on-time and within 4% of budget. (See Retail Case Study)
- **Top-5 Energy Company - Digital Transformation:** Provided PMO support for 24-month, 110-person cloud

migration program. Managed RAID log with 450+ items, coordinated resource onboarding/offboarding for 180 team members over program lifecycle, and designed resource utilization dashboard in Power BI. (See Energy Case Study)

- **Fortune 500 Financial Services - Core Banking:** Supported PMO for 85-person core banking modernization. Managed defect tracking across 3 parallel testing cycles, maintained change request log, and coordinated bi-weekly regulatory update meetings with OCC relationship management team.

Training Completed

- Meridian PMO Foundations Program (2024)
- Smartsheet Advanced Administration - Internal Course (2024)
- Meridian Professional Communications Workshop (2025)
- PMP Exam Preparation - In Progress (targeting Q3 2026)